

ETERNAL

HR Policy Document
Version 1.0 | Effective March 2026

Last Updated: March 2026 | Applies to all permanent and contract staff

1. Introduction

This document sets out the human resources policies applicable to all employees of Eternal, a creative and brand consultancy headquartered in Dubai, UAE. These policies reflect both our legal obligations and our commitment to building a workplace where people can do the best work of their careers. All staff are expected to be familiar with this document. Queries should be directed to people@eternal.ae.

2. Annual Leave

2.1 Entitlement

All full-time employees receive **22 days** of paid annual leave per year, in addition to UAE public holidays as gazetted. Entitlement accrues at 1.83 days per month. New joiners begin accruing from day one but may not take leave during their probation period without prior approval from their Head of Department.

2.2 Booking and Approval

- Leave requests must be submitted in Workday with a minimum of 10 business days' notice.
- During peak client periods (typically late Q3 and Q4), leave may be restricted at the discretion of Department Heads.
- A maximum of 5 days may be carried forward to the next calendar year; all other unused leave is forfeited.
- Employees taking more than 10 consecutive days must notify their Head of Department at least 4 weeks in advance.

3. Sick Leave

3.1 Entitlement

Employees are entitled to **15 days** of paid sick leave per calendar year in line with UAE Labour Law. The first 5 days are paid in full; days 6–15 are paid at 50% of basic salary. Sick leave beyond 15 days is unpaid unless covered by the company's group medical insurance policy.

3.2 Reporting Absence

- Employees must inform their line manager by 9:00 AM on the first day of absence via phone or Slack.
- Absences of 2 or more consecutive days require a medical certificate from a licensed UAE clinic or hospital.
- Three or more instances of uncertified sick leave within a rolling 6-month period will trigger a welfare discussion.

4. Parental Leave

Eternal exceeds the statutory minimum to support working parents at all stages.

- **Primary Carer Leave (Maternity/Adoption):** 14 weeks fully paid from the date of birth or placement.

- **Secondary Carer Leave (Paternity):** 10 working days fully paid, to be taken within the first 8 weeks.
- **Shared Parental Leave:** Following the initial primary carer period, the remaining leave may be shared between eligible partners, to a combined maximum of 18 weeks between both carers.
- Employees must notify HR at least 8 weeks before the expected start date. Return-to-work plans should be discussed at least 4 weeks before the end of leave.

5. Remote Working Policy

Eternal operates a hybrid working model. The default expectation is office presence, with flexibility built in for focused and deep-work tasks.

- Employees may work remotely **up to 2 days per week**, subject to manager approval and business needs.
- Client-facing days, shoots, presentations, and all-hands meetings are mandatory in-person unless expressly agreed otherwise.
- Remote working arrangements are not a contractual right and may be adjusted based on performance or project demands.
- Employees must be reachable on Slack and email during contracted hours regardless of location.
- Employees working outside the UAE for more than 10 consecutive calendar days must notify HR in advance due to potential tax and visa implications.

6. Overtime

Eternal operates in a fast-paced creative environment where occasional extended hours may be necessary. However, the company is committed to sustainable working practices.

- Overtime for salaried employees is not automatically compensated but will be recognised through Time Off in Lieu (TOIL) at a 1:1 ratio.
- TOIL must be agreed with your line manager before the overtime is worked and taken within 60 days.
- Hourly-rate or contract employees are compensated for overtime at 1.25x their standard rate on weekdays and 1.5x on weekends and public holidays.
- No employee may work more than 48 hours per week on a sustained basis. Concerns should be raised with HR.

7. Performance Review Schedule

Performance at Eternal is reviewed on a **quarterly basis**, with a formal annual summary review each December. The schedule is as follows:

- **Q1 Check-in (March):** Objective-setting and alignment for the year ahead.
- **Q2 Mid-point Review (June):** Progress assessment and course correction if needed.
- **Q3 Development Focus (September):** Skills gap analysis and learning plan review.
- **Annual Review (December):** Comprehensive performance assessment; informs salary review, bonus, and promotion decisions.

All reviews are conducted in Workday. Both parties must complete self-assessments at least 48 hours before the scheduled meeting.

8. Disciplinary Procedure

Eternal manages conduct and performance issues fairly, transparently, and consistently.

- 1 **Verbal Caution:** Informal discussion between the employee and their line manager. No written record placed on file. Intent is to correct and support.
- 2 **First Written Warning:** Issued following a formal hearing with HR present. Active on file for 9 months.
- 3 **Final Written Warning:** Issued where improvement has not been sufficient or the matter is serious. Active on file for 18 months.
- 4 **Dismissal:** Reserved for gross misconduct or sustained failure following prior warnings. A panel of at least two senior managers must be involved.

Employees have the right to be accompanied at all formal stages and to appeal any decision within 7 working days of written notification.